

DRAFT Questions on E. Alameda project....

From: "Kuhn, Nancy - DOTI Marketing and Communications Director" <Nancy.Kuhn@denvergov.org>
To: "Holloway; Tykus R. - DOTI Deputy Manager" <Tykus.Holloway@denvergov.org>; "Hillhouse; Jennifer L. - DOTI City Planning Director" <Jennifer.Hillhouse@denvergov.org>; "Eisinger; John R. - DOTI CE2777 Manager Engineering and Science" <John.Eisinger@denvergov.org>; "Price; Brittany C. - DOTI CE2781 Engineer-Architect Manager" <Brittany.Price@denvergov.org>; "Cieciek; Gregory M. - DOTI CE2294 Project Manager II Engineering" <Gregory.Cieciek@denvergov.org>; "Lanphier; Molly - DOTI CE2294 Project Manager II Engineering" <Molly.Lanphier@denvergov.org>; "Ford; Amy - DOTI HE3258 Manager Department of Transportation and Infrastructure" <Amy.Ford@denvergov.org>
Date: 2025-05-14 10:30:01-06:00
Attachments: image001.png, alr-constant contact.pdf, alr-neighbor-letter.pdf, For the Love of Safety billboard.jpg

DRAFT Alamada response for review...

Hi Mark,

Starting with a little overview:

Yes, the basic goals are to improve safety and reduce crashes. Alameda Avenue is on our high injury network – the streets where most fatal and serious injury crashes are occurring in the city. We began hearing concerns about safety on Alameda Ave between Lincoln and Franklin streets from the community a few years back. We did an analysis and found issues of speeding and vehicle rear-end and turning collisions due to a lack of left hand turn lanes. The community was also requesting pedestrian crossing improvements to help people get to the nearby school and businesses along Alameda more easily and safely, given all the vehicle activity.

With that, we developed a design that would work to slow vehicle speeds and reduce incidents of rear end and left turn collisions. The design provides drivers one vehicle travel lane in each direction on Alameda Avenue between Lincoln and Franklin, adding a center turning lane in many sections for safer turning movements - a place for drivers to be while they wait to make a turn, preventing backups in the through-travel lane and the unsafe maneuvers drivers sometimes take to get around cars waiting to turn.

We went into the community last year to update residents on the proposed design. Shortly thereafter, in June, we launched our SPEED initiative<<https://denvergov.org/Government/Agencies-Departments-Offices/Agencies-Departments-Offices-Directory/Department-of-Transportation-and-Infrastructure/News-Outreach/News/Reduce-Traffic-Fatalities>>, which is deploying other targeted actions to reduce speeds on Alameda Avenue from city limit to city limit. The SPEED measures we have completed since June include:

- * Saturating the corridor with speed limit signage, increasing sign density to approximately every ¼ mile to raise awareness of the speed limit.
- * Placing additional electronic feedback signs along the corridor to communicate driver speeds.
- * Programming traffic signals to slow vehicles down to the posted speed limits.
- * Shortening signal cycle lengths in the overnight hours, reducing the amount of time that signals rest in green, discouraging speeding when vehicle volumes are low.
- * Increasing the number of intersections on Federal and Alameda with leading pedestrian intervals, or LPIs. LPIs give pedestrians a head start crossing the street and an opportunity to establish themselves in an intersection for greater visibility before cars get the green.
- * Worked with Xcel to increase visibility on the corridors by addressing any damaged/dark street lights
- * Completed a Slow Down for the Love of Safety billboard campaign, telling people to Slow Down. Picture attached.

Up next: The SPEED initiative also calls for deploying fixed, automated speed enforcement cameras on Alameda Ave and Federal Blvd. This would be the first time Denver has used this technology and we just learned that in late spring/early summer, we will have a chance to test the technology. We will not be testing the speed enforcement aspect of the fixed camera just yet (people won't be getting tickets), but we will have an opportunity to see how the

cameras work, and to also gather updated speed data on this stretch of Alameda, which may serve to verify or update the speeding issues we have seen in the past.

The testing of these cameras may push out our implementation of the lane repurposing project a bit, also affording us some time to address any new or lingering community concerns about the lane repurposing plan.

Responses to your questions are below!

From: Mark Samuelson <mark@samuelsonassoc.com>

Sent: Monday, May 12, 2025 4:51 PM

To: Kuhn, Nancy - DOTI Marketing and Communications Director <Nancy.Kuhn@denvergov.org>

Subject: [EXTERNAL] And a correction on those questions....

By the way, Nancy, looks like my question #4 should refer to Downing and MARION, not Downing and Corona. Intersections along Alameda at Downing and Marion will be restricted to just two thru lanes?

From: Mark Samuelson

Sent: Monday, May 12, 2025 4:02 PM

To: Nancy Kuhn (nancy.kuhn@denvergov.org<mailto:nancy.kuhn@denvergov.org>)

<nancy.kuhn@denvergov.org<mailto:nancy.kuhn@denvergov.org>>

Subject: Questions on E. Alameda project...

Hi Nancy! Couple of questions on that, after having gone through the materials...

1. I assume basic goal remains to improve safety and reduce serious accidents? I read about the HIN accident corridor focus, and assume that's still primary... Correct

2. Went thru the video of the zoom meeting on this in 2021. Am I correct that the plan to close Alameda down to just two thru lanes at Downing and MARION is a new element to the plan? I thought I recall in the meeting that those intersections would remain as before. There are currently two travel lanes on Alameda in each direction at the intersections of Downing and Marion and no left turns are permitted from Alameda onto Downing or Marion. Here, it will got to one lane in each direction, consistent with what's happening on either side. No left turns will be permitted, as is the case right now. The center or middle travel lanes of Alameda at these intersections will be re-stripped to offer a safer pedestrian crossing. Pedestrians will have to cross two vehicle travel lanes on Alameda instead of four and the striping plan will provide a mid-block pedestrian refuge. Here's a visual of that:

3. Are you holding another public meeting before the start of construction on that? Are area residents aware of the final plan for the entire stretch, including at Downing and MARION? Below is a look at some of the outreach we've done so far and recently. We typically engage the community through traditional media/social media as we get closer to construction and will review what other methods might be needed or helpful as we get closer. My understanding is that businesses along this stretch have been very supportive.

Data Collection: October-December 2019

Analysis/ Alternatives Evaluation: January-March 2020

Public Outreach: May 2020

Design Procurement – August 2021

Design: Fall 2023

Public Outreach: 3/20/24

Constant Contact Notification on 2/4/25 – attached

Flyered corridor on April 14, 2025 – attached

4. When do you plan for construction to begin? No confirmed date. Per note above, we want to test out the fixed camera technology on Alameda and Federal; that may adjust the anticipated schedule for the Alameda lane repurposing work, which was planned for mid-year/summer 2025.

5. Looks like that 5-foot buffer on both the north and south sides of Alameda, east of Pearl to Humboldt. Are those to become bike lanes? Would they have flex posts or other vertical structures? No plans to install a bike lane. The buffer supports narrowing the roadway to one lane in each direction.

6. Are you planning speed cameras as part of the project? Speed cameras are a separate effort, but yes, our goal is to

deploy fixed, automatic speed camera technology on our Federal and Alameda corridors, for starters, before the end of the year. We will be doing community outreach before installation to help people understand that technology better. 7. I read in your details that there had been a previous attempt to reduce the lanes a decade ago that had caused backups, and that the new plan is based on traffic counts that have been revised downward? When were those done? DOTI installed a lane reduction on Alameda back in the 2008-2010 timeframe in the eastbound direction at Downing, which resulted in a stacking of vehicles on the eastbound approach to Downing Street. During that time, the Alameda average daily traffic was over 20,000. Average daily traffic on that stretch is now much lower, so Alameda is a better candidate now for a lane reduction.

Thanks, Nancy; feel free to call if I can clarify....

Mark Samuelson
The Denver Gazette
303-641-0196
mark@marksamuelson.com<mailto:mark@marksamuelson.com>
DenverGazette.com

Extracted attachments

image001.png
alr-constant contact.pdf
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For the Love of Safety billboard.jpg